

2016 年 3 月公共英语三级真题

SECTION I Listening

(25 minutes)

Directions:

This section is designed to test your ability to understand spoken English. You will hear a selection of recorded materials and you must answer the questions that accompany them. There are two parts in this section, Part A and Part B.

Remember, while you are doing the test, you should first put down your answers in your test booklet. At the end of the listening comprehension section, you will have 3 minutes to transfer your answers from your test booklet onto your ANSWER SHEET.

If you have any questions, you may raise your hand now as you will not be allowed to speak once the test has started.

Now look at Part A in your test booklet.

Part A

Directions:

*You will hear 10 short dialogues. For each dialogue, there is one question and four possible answers. Choose the correct answer—A, B, C or D, and mark it in your test booklet. You will have 15 seconds to answer the question and you will hear each dialogue **only once**.*

1. What is the woman doing at the moment?

- [A] Having a break.
- [B] Having a coffee.
- [C] Writing a report.
- [D] Visiting the man.

2. What does the woman ask the man to do?

- [A]Repair her windows.
- [B] Take care of her house.
- [C] Take a rest for a few days.
- [D] Go to the seaside with her.

3. What do we learn about the woman from the dialogue?

- [A]She bought a suitable skirt.
- [B] She wanted to purchase a skirt.

- [C] She returned a skirt to the shop
- [D] She complained about the service
- 4.What does the man say to the woman?
- [A] He envies her a lot.
- [B] He enjoys cooking.
- [C] He usually eats out.
- [D] He runs a restaurant.
- 5.What are the speakers talking about?
- [A] Gardening. [B] Air quality.
- [C] Hot weather. [D] Lack of rain.
- 6.Why is the woman angry with her son?
- [A] He ignored traffic signals.
- [B] He failed to repair her car.
- [C] He didn't attend his class.
- [D] He didn't take her advice.
- 7.Why does the man feel sorry?
- [A] He forgot his Dad's birthday.
- [B] He didn't buy a birthday present.
- [C] He didn't put the cake in the fridge.
- [D] He arrived late for his dad's birthday.
- 8.Where is the man's house located?
- [A] Near a park. [B] By a restaurant.
- [C] Close to a highway. [D] In a Chinese neighborhood.
- 9.What does the woman say about the data in the article?
- [A] It is original. [B] It is reliable.
- [C] It is questionable. [D] It is authoritative.
- 10.What does the man tell the woman?
- [A] The best time for job interviews.
- [B] The strategies for job interviews.
- [C] His comments on her recent work.
- [D] His congratulations on her good luck.

Part B

Directions:

*You will hear four dialogues or monologues. Before listening to each one, you will have 5 seconds to read each of the questions which accompany it. While listening, answer each question by choosing A, B, C or D. After listening, you will have 10 seconds to check your answer to each question. You will hear the recording **only once**.*

Questions 11 -13 are based on the following dialogue.

11. What is the man's first tip on a productive workday?

- [A] Arrive at the office earlier.
- [B] Jump into paper work first.
- [C] Start with less difficult tasks.
- [D] Get ready within 15 minutes.

12. Why should personal phone calls be avoided?

- [A] They may take a lot of time.
- [B] They may reduce social time.
- [C] They may spoil a great mood.
- [D] They may cause errors in work.

13. Why should an alarm be set?

- [A] To give a go-home signal.
- [B] To remind people to relax.
- [C] To make people work fast.
- [D] To warn people of an emergency.

Questions 14 - 17 are based on the following conversation between two friends.

14. What news does Renee share with Tom?

- [A] She met a high school classmate.
- [B] She found an old friend's address.
- [C] She paid a visit to her high school,
- [D] She got in touch with an old friend.

15. Why did Renee and her friend lose contact?

- [A] Her friend's family left for another city.
- [B] Her friend transferred to another school,
- [C] They had an argument and drifted apart.
- [D] They were too busy to write to each other.

16. What does Tom say about his old friends?
- [A] He has lost touch with all of them.
 - [B] He maintains contact with most of them.
 - [C] He has regained contact with a few of them.
 - [D] He keeps in touch with one or two of them.

17. How did Renee's friend get her email address?
- [A] From an old address book.
 - [B] From one of their former teachers.
 - [C] From another high school classmate.
 - [D] From the website of Renee's company.

Questions 18 -21 are based on a conversation between Lisa and her former neighbor John.

18. Why did the woman decide to cancel her vacation?
- [A] She had trouble with her health.
 - [B] She had trouble with her investment.
 - [C] She had to attend a financial course.
 - [D] She had to attend a conference in Paris.
19. What did the woman do after she graduated from college?
- [A] She worked as a stock trader.
 - [B] She worked as a stock analyst.
 - [C] She worked as a finance teacher.
 - [D] She worked as a company manager.

20. Why did the woman want to start her own company?
- [A] To make more money.
 - [B] To have more time for herself.
 - [C] To find more business opportunities.
 - [D] To know more about the stock market.

21. How does the woman feel about the present economic stimulating package?
- [A] Relieved.
 - [B] Optimistic.
 - [C] Unconfident.
 - [D] Disappointed.

Questions 22 -25 are based on the following interview between a reporter and Mr. Smith on his website.

22. Which industry is the man's website concerned with?
- [A] News.
 - [B] Music.
 - [C] Education.
 - [D] Television

23. Whom is the man's website mainly meant for?

- [A] College students in Asia.
- [B] English learners of all ages.
- [C] Teenagers and young adults.
- [D] Any visitors for entertainment.

24. What does the website want its visitors to get familiar with?

- [A] Classic films. [B] Western music.
- [C] English accents. [D] Public speeches.

25. What does the man hope his website will do in three years?

- [A] Fulfill its short-term goal. [B] Get a big market in Asia.
- [C] Become self-financed. [D] Get more investments

Now you have 3 minutes to transfer your answers from your test booklet to your ANSWER SHEET.

That is the end of Listening Comprehension.

SECTION II Reading

(50 minutes)

Part A

Directions:

Read the following two texts. Answer the questions on each text by choosing A, B, C or D. Mark your answers on your ANSWER SHEET.

Text 1

Isabel has turned down two job offers in the past year. In 2006, she started her own consulting practice, but by 2008, most of her larger clients had to drop her because of the economy. In 2011, she was undertaking irregular assignments and knew she needed a steady job. The first job she considered was Director of HR for a company in Utah. After the initial interviews, she felt the job fit her except for the location. Still, she flew west to meet the hiring manager. The hiring manager explained that Isabel was the top candidate for the job but that, before she continued with the process, she should better understand the firm's culture. She

directed Isabel to several videos of the company's CEO, who regularly appeared in front of the company in costume as part of morale building exercises and expected his senior leaders to do the same. "Even though I was desperate for a job, I knew I couldn't do that," Isabel says. She called the recruiter to turn down the job and explained that she didn't feel there was a cultural fit.

A few months later, she interviewed for another job: a director of employee relations at a local university. After several interviews, the hiring manager told her the job was hers if she wanted it. The job had many positives: it was a low-stress environment, it offered great benefits, and the university was an employee-friendly place. But the job was relatively junior despite the title and Isabel worried it wouldn't be challenging enough. Finally, she turned it down. "It would be great to have a paycheck and great benefits but I would definitely have trouble sleeping at night," she says.

In both cases, she was frank with the hiring managers about why she wasn't taking the jobs. "In the past, it felt like dating, I was worried about hurting people's feelings," she says. However, they appreciated her frankness and thanked her for her honesty. She says it was hard to turn down the jobs and it was a risk for her financially but she felt she had to.

26. In 2011, Isabel _____.

- [A] did consulting now and then
- [B] found a job close to her home
- [C] refused several job interviews
- [D] ran a successful consulting firm

27. Isabel turned down the first job offer mainly because of its _____.

- [A] CEO
- [B] culture
- [C] location
- [D] recruiter

28. Isabel was dissatisfied with the second job due to its _____.

- [A] junior title
- [B] low benefits
- [C] environment
- [D] lack of challenge

29. Isabel believed that her rejection of the jobs was _____.

- [A] harmful
- [B] surprising
- [C] justifiable
- [D] troublesome

30. According to Isabel, it is important to _____.

- [A] look for jobs with little stress
- [B] look for jobs with great benefits

[C] be truthful in declining job offers

[D] be cautious in declining job offers

Text 2

You do not usually get something for nothing. Now, a new study reveals that the evolution of an improved learning ability could come at a particularly high price: an earlier death.

Past experiments have demonstrated that it is relatively easy through selective breeding to make rats, honey bees and-that great favourite of researchers-fruit flies a lot better at learning. Animals that are better learners should be competitive and, thus, over time, come to dominate a population by natural selection. But improved learning ability does not get selected amongst these animals in the wild. No one really understands why.

Tadeusz Kawecki and his colleagues at the University of Fribourg in Switzerland have measured the effects of improved learning on the lives of fruit flies. The flies were given two different fruits as egg-laying sites. One of these was laced with a bitter additive that could be detected only on contact. The flies were then given the same fruit but without an additive. Flies that avoided the fruit which had been bitter were deemed to have learned from their experience. Their children were reared and the experiment was run again.

After repeating the experiment for 30 generations, the children of the learned flies were compared with normal flies. The researchers report in a forthcoming edition of *Evolution* that although learning ability could be bred into a population of fruit flies, it shortened their lives by 15%. When the researchers compared their learned flies to colonies selectively bred to live long lives, they found even greater differences. Whereas learned flies had reduced their life spans, the long-lived flies learned less well than even average flies.

The authors suggest that evolving an improved learning ability may require a greater investment in the nervous system which takes resources away from processes that delay ageing. However, Dr. Kawecki thinks the effect could also be a by-product of greater brain activity increasing the production of Reactive Oxygen Species (ROS) , which can increase oxidation in the body and damage health.

No one knows whether the phenomenon holds true for other animals. So, biologists, at least, still have a lot to learn.

31. Past experiments prove selective breeding can make animals better_____

[A] commanders

[B] competitors

[C] survivors

[D] learners

32. In this experiment, scientists observed that _____
- [A] some flies avoided the fruit without an addictive
 - [B] some flies preferred the fruit with an addictive
 - [C] the eggs of the flies were not damaged
 - [D] the impact on the flies did not last long
33. The forthcoming report says that _____
- [A] long-lived flies are better at laying eggs
 - [B] long-lived flies are poorer in learning
 - [C] learned flies have a relatively long life
 - [D] learned flies live as long as average ones
34. According to Dr. Kawecki, greater brain activity _____
- [A] reduces oxygen consumption
 - [B] regulates the nervous system
 - [C] speeds up the ageing process
 - [D] stabilizes the ageing process
35. We learn from the text that _____
- [A] the research findings need to be tested further
 - [B] biologists are doing similar research on other animals
 - [C] the animal world usually follows the same universal laws
 - [D] biologists are applying their findings to other areas

Part B

Directions:

Read the texts from a magazine article in which five people talk about tipping in a restaurant. For questions 36-40, match the name of each person to one of the statements (A-G) given below.

Mark your answers on your ANSWER SHEET.

Richard:

I've always viewed tipping as a way of saying "thank you" to the one who serves me. I believe what is bad is when no tip is left at all. The better the service, the higher the tip. Unless the service is literally perfect, I never tip more than 10% of the bill. Much like the harder teachers in school, I never give an easy "A." My assessment is honest.

Daniel:

A tip is a "thank you," but in truth, a tip is payment for service. 20% is a standard tip. Servers deserve it for their hard work. Restaurants will never pay more for labor unless they are forced to do so by new laws. Tips make up about 97% of a server's total income. Those tips are needed for survival. So, before servers are paid a living wage, tip 20%.

Kate:

Why should I pay the difference between what the restaurant is willing to pay the employee and what an acceptable wage is? I do pay 20% , but I hate it. A friend of mine left Europe for New York City, found a job in a restaurant there and ended up making \$5,500 a month. Enough above minimum wage? How about miners, construction workers, resident doctors, etc? Do they get tipped?

Patricia:

18 -20% for good service is today's standard. The restaurant and its employees are too polite to tell you this or to put it on their menus, but that is their expectation and you need to understand that. I believe it is good manners to respect this. To do otherwise is to be openly rude. If you disagree ,you are wise to eat elsewhere, as you are hurting a hardworking professional.

Michael:

Tipping has gotten out of control. I always had thought it was 15% , and now suddenly servers have made it 20%. I tip 15% , and that's it. If the service is really superior, then I work higher from there. Interesting to be told, "If you can't afford to tip 20% , then you should eat at home." If all those people stayed away, the restaurant would not even be in business.

Now match the name of each person (36 - 40) to the appropriate statement.

Note: there are two extra statements.

- | | |
|--------------|--|
| 36. Richard | [A] It's rude not to tip. |
| 37. Daniel | [B] I do tip, though I don't like it. |
| 38. Kate | [C] Tipping shouldn't be compulsory. |
| 39. Patricia | [D] Tips are essential to servers' survival. |
| 40. Michael | [E] If you don't tip, you are punishing the server. |
| | [F] I think the current tipping standard is too high. |
| | [G] My tip faithfully reflects how good the service is |

Part C

Directions:

Read the following text from which five sentences have been removed. Choose from the sentences A—G the most suitable one to fill each numbered gap in the text (41 -45). There are TWO extra sentences that you do not need to use. Mark your answers on your ANSWER SHEET.

In 2009, the number of hungry people in the world reached one billion for the first time. It's difficult not to be shocked by the fact that more than one in seven people in the world do not have enough to eat. 41 Hunger kills more people per year than diseases such as AIDS, malaria and TB combined.

The UN estimates that almost two thirds of the world's hungry people are in Asia, which is of course the world's most populous continent. 42_____ Although this region has a much lower population than Asia, it has the highest percentage of hungry people. Almost all of the rest are in Latin America, North Africa and the Caribbean. In the richest regions of the world there are only a tiny number of people who don't have enough to eat.

There are many reasons for world hunger. They include wars, droughts, floods, and the overuse of farming land. 43 Many people also blame greedy businessmen for pushing up the prices of basic foods in the global market. But the most important reason, quite simply, is poverty, which has increased recently due to the financial crisis of 2008.

Although many people make the obvious point that there would be less hunger if the global population were smaller, few people would argue that there is not enough food to go around.

44 In the last 50 years, global food production has risen even more quickly than the global population. There are many areas of the world in which people generally have more than enough food. 45 The answer to world hunger, therefore, may be a balanced food distribution around the whole world. Everyone will have enough to eat, but not overeat.

[A] The basic problem seems to be not a lack of food, but its distribution.

[B] More than a quarter are in sub-Saharan Africa.

[C] All these factors affect food production.

[D] It takes the effort of every country to fight against world hunger.

[E] In those places, obesity is a far bigger problem than hunger.

[F] Those places need far more food than they actually get.

[G] By the end of this year, more than 35 million people will have died as a result of not having

enough to eat.

Part D

Directions:

Read the following text from which 10 words have been removed. Choose from the words A - O the most suitable one to fill each numbered gap in the text (46-55). There are FIVE extra words that you do not need to use. Mark your answers on your ANSWER SHEET

I can't believe the kind of rubbish that some people call art. Yesterday, my girlfriend dragged me to a modern art 46____ to see an exhibition she had read about in the paper. It was five or six so-called installations made of bits of plastic, wood and paper that 47_____ just to have been thrown on the floor. It was a mess, basically—just like the floor in my sister's house when my two-year- old nephew's left all his toys out, but less 48_____. Come to think of it, 49_____you had given those bits of plastic, wood and paper to my nephew, he could probably have 50_____ something just as good. I guess, sometimes, the cleaners end up throwing art like that in the bins at the end of the day, 51_____ they must find it hard to work out what's an exhibit and what's just 52_____. I think that if a painting or an installation looks like something I could have done myself in fifteen minutes, it doesn't 53_____ to be called art. But when I say that, people like my girlfriend say I'm "uncultured." I think a lot of the people who say they 54_____ the kind of stuff we saw yesterday are just pretending—deep down they know it's rubbish but they don't want to be the first one to admit it because, unlike me, they're 55 _____ of being looked down on.

- | | | |
|--------------|----------------|-------------|
| [A] afraid | [B] appreciate | [C] because |
| [D] colorful | [E] created | [F] deserve |
| [G] dislike | [H] gallery | [I] if |
| [J] litter | [K] object | [L] proved |
| [M] seemed | [N] serious | [O] when |

SECTION III Writing

(45 minutes)

Directions:

You should write your responses to both Part A and Part B of this section on your ANSWER SHEET.

Part A

56. You have just had a terrible trip to a foreign country. Post a message to an English online forum;

- 1) telling other travelers some of your bad experiences ;
- 2) giving them some suggestions about taking a trip.

You should write about 100 words. Do not sign your own name at the end of your message. Use "Wang Lin" instead.

Part B

Directions: 57.

Read the text below : Write an essay in about 120 words, in which you should summarize the key points of the text and make comments on them. Try to use your own words.

Dear Sally,

It was amazing to see your dance performance last weekend. I felt so proud of you when your teacher and schoolmates congratulated you upon your completion of the performance.

While you continue to enjoy the moment, I'd like to share with you a small quote from Abraham Lincoln, "This, too, shall pass away. " I want these words to be your guide at every turning point in your life.

When you're feeling very proud of yourself at an achievement, knowing no bounds at that moment, remember that "This, too, shall pass away."

When you're at a difficult moment in your life and don't know what to do, find comfort in the same words—, "This, too, shall pass away."

I'm not saying that the ache of some losses and setbacks will completely go away from your life. In fact, often the memories of painful events will hit you unexpectedly like tons of bricks and take your breath away years after they happen.

But, like all humans, you have an almost infinite capacity to adapt to life's changes and a great ability to bounce back from trying times. This understanding should give you a spark of hope when you're in a season of despair; it should also build up your confidence for taking risks in the future.

Sally, our lives are made up of several peaks and several valleys. That's the nature of life. Live each moment as it comes. And always remember "This, too, shall pass away."

Love,
Papa

THAT IS THE END OF THE TEST